



1521

CONQUEST OF THE AZTECS

Arriving in Mexico in 1519, Spanish soldier Hernán Cortés advanced to the Aztec capital Tenochtitlan. He was repulsed with heavy losses but allied with enemies of the Aztecs and returned in 1521 to besiege the city. Weakened by disease, the Aztecs were overrun in August. Emperor Cuauhtémoc was captured and later killed.

◀ The retreat of Hernán Cortés from Tenochtitlan in 1520

1520

1525 The Battle of Pavia

sees French King Francis I defeated and taken prisoner by Emperor Charles V

1521 **Martin Luther** is declared a heretic, sealing the Protestant-Catholic schism

1526

MUGHAL EMPIRE FOUNDED

Babur, a Muslim warrior descended from Genghis Khan, invaded India from Afghanistan and defeated the Sultan of Delhi at the battle of Panipat in April 1526. By his death in 1530 he had extended his rule over most of northern India, founding the Mughal Empire. His descendants would preside over a golden age of stability and cultural flowering in India.

▷ Babur holding court

